Humpty Dumpty Egg-splodes

By Kevin O'Malley

MR. HATCHERY: Hi kids, I'm Mr. Hatchery. Your teacher, Mrs. Boardering, asked me to take part in "Read Across America Day." Today I'm going to read the wonderful book *The Nursery Rhymes of Mother Goose: Favorite Rhymes for Young and Old . . . (clears his throat and begins reading in a very flat voice)* Mary had a little lamb. Her fleece was white as snow.

MRS. BOARDERING: Mr. Hatchery? I'm going to step down to the teachers' lounge for a minute.

MR. HATCHERY: *(silently acknowledging Mrs. B)* And everywhere that Mary went, the lamb was sure to go.

STUDENT: Boring! What does your dad do anyway?

STUDENT 2: Aw . . . jeez, Dad. He works in an office.

MR. HATCHERY: It followed her to school one day, which was against the rules. *(closing the book and addressing the class)* Does anybody know what happens next? Anybody? No? *(and suddenly his demeanor changes)* Well, she found a giant egg ***crushing*** the school. It wasn't just any egg, oh no! It was an . . . Egg-Ceedingly large **Humpty Dumpty**!!

INTRODUCTION

Humpty Dumpty has wigged out. Furious about being teased and taunted for his round and bald body and his bad habit of falling off walls, Humpty is wreaking havoc throughout Mother Goose Land. And with Mother Goose out of town, it's up to Old King Cole to put things right. But as the king points out, he's a merry old soul, not a smart one. Luckily, he has Jack Be Nimble to help him pick up the pieces.

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Mr. Hatchery now acts out the story becoming each of the characters . . .

MARY: Humpty Dumpty, what happened to you? You're huge! *(think Godzilla size)*

HUMPTY: That's right. I'm huge and I'm not gonna take it anymore! *(mimicking the townsfolk who taunt him)* "Oh, look, the tubby bald eggman is falling off the wall, Haa, haa, haa."

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(sarcastically) Did anybody ever think how painful it would be to have a horse try to put you back together? No! So I'm back, baby! Say good-bye to Mother Goose Land!

MR. HATCHERY: Mary ran back to Jack's house as fast as her dress would let her.

MARY: Jack be nimble, Jack be quick, Jack jump over the candlestick, and get over to Old King Cole's place fast!

JACK: *(jumping over a candlestick)* Hey, Mary, can't you see I'm working here? Do you think this is easy? *(knocks the candlestick over and has to reset it and try again – he's not very nimble)*

MARY: Humpty Dumpty's back and he's gonna stomp the town. Hurry!

MR. HATCHERY: Old King Cole was a merry old soud until Jack came running in.

KING COLE: What? Humpty Dumpty's gonna wreck the town? What am I supposed to do? I'm not a smart king, just a merry one. The real brains of the town is Mother Goose and she's away on vacation getting her feathers fluffed!

JACK: Well, you'd better think of something quick. Humpty Dumpty's headed this way.

KING COLE: *(thinking, which is very hard for him)* I've got it. Get me Peter Piper. . . *(Jacks exits and returns with Peter)* Peter Piper, pick me a peck of pickled peppers then throw them at Humpty Dumpty. He hates pickled peppers.

PETER: Yes sir, Sire! *(races to rapid-fire as many peppers as he can at HD)*

HUMPTY: *(catching some in his mouth; others in his hands which he stuffs in his mouth)* I've learned to love pickled peppers!

PETER: *(returns to the King)* Your Highness, it didn't work. Humpty just ate the peppers. *(dejected, Peter exits)*

KING COLE: *(to Jack)* How many pecks of pickled peppers did Peter Piper pick?

JACK: He pitched pickled peppers until he was positively popped. Should I try calling Mother Hubbard?

KING COLE: Naw, what's she got to throw at Humpty? Her cupboard is always bare. Besides, she's never at home and you'd end up talking to that smart aleck dog. Let's call the Grand Old Duke of York.

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JACK: Good idea! He's got ten thousand men. *(picking up the phone)*

(pantomime a great battle with Humpty, with Humpty roaring and winning and the men losing and screaming)

DUKE: Retreat!!!

JACK: *(lowering his spy glass and shaking his head)* No good, Sire. He marched them all straight up the hill and he marched them down again.

KING COLE: I should have known.

JACK: I could try the Old Woman that Lives in the Shoe.

KING COLE: Naw, she's got so many children she won't know what to do.

JACK: *(looking out the window)* Sire?! Come quick! Humpty's crashing through the town! *(Humpty rampages)*

MR. HATCHERY: Humpty Dumpty was on a rampage. He found Jack Horner sitting in the corner. He stole his plum, Christmas pie and all. He sat on Little Miss Muffet's tuffet and ate all her curds and whey. He shook the whole town. Things were looking bad.

HUMPTY: *(singing as he destroys the bridge)* London Bridge is falling down!

TOWNSPERSON: Falling down, falling down. London Bridge is falling down. My fair lady???

KING COLE: *(to Jack)* I've got it. You know Peter . . . Peter Pumpkin Eater?

JACK: Oh, sure. I heard his wife got out of the pumpkin shell. I believe she's doing very well.

KING COLE: Yes, yes, yes. Go and tell Peter to roll that pumpkin downtown. I want him to stuff Humpty in it. *(pantomime of Peter rolling the pumpkin at Humpty)*

HUMPTY: Look . . . It's a squash! *(stomping the pumpkin to bits)* Roses are red, violets are blue. Pumpkins are orange, and the town is too!

KING COLE: *(to Jack, running out of ideas)* I've got it! Do you know the Muffin Man?

JACK: *(unsure)* The Muffin Man?

KING COLE: The Muffin Man! Do you know the Muffin Man?

JACK: Oh sure, he lives on Drurey Lane.

KING COLE: Well, go to him and tell him to lay a path of muffins down Main Street. Tell him to make a left onto Wall Street. We'll drive Humpty Dumpty right up the wall! *(pantomime the Muffin Man laying a trail of muffins)*

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MR. HATCHERY: *(very animated)* Wrecking a town is hard work. Humpty was really hungry. He followed the muffin trail just as Old King Cole had hoped. *(bending, snapping and popping muffins; he follows the trail right up the wall and sits there eating)*

KING COLE: Now we have to find a way to push him off. That'll knock some sense into him.

JACK: *(running back into the throne room)* Sire, Sire! Dr. Foster, on his way to Gloucester, reports that Mother Goose is on her way back home.

KING COLE: *(with a huge sigh of relief)* Thank goodness. Now I can get back to being merry.

MOTHER GOOSE: *(flying in the window, she collides with King Cole and they struggle to untangle themselves)* The town's a mess. What's going on here? I can't even go away for the weekend without this place going to pieces.

MR. HATCHERY: Old King Cole filled Mother Goose in about Humpty Dumpty's rampage.

MOTHER GOOSE: *(honking, hissing and yelling)* Get me all the king's horses and all the king's men! Send them all to the wall!

JACK: *(saluting)* Yes, Ma'am! *(he races off)*

MR. HATCHERY: Meanwhile, Humpty was almost finished with his muffins. He was extremely full. He was getting very sleepy. *(HD begins to drift off and as he does so, he slips off the wall) (in a sing-song voice)* Humpty Dumpty sat on the wall. Humpty Dumpty had a great fall. All the king's horses and all the king's men . . . *(building suspense)* held out a giant sheet and caught him!

JACK: *(to Mother Goose)* What are you going to do with him now?

MOTHER GOOSE: Get me Gregory Griggs.

JACK: Gregory Griggs? Had twenty-seven different wigs? He wore them up, he wore them down to please the people of the town? [that] Gregory Griggs?

MOTHER GOOSE: *(impatient)* Yes, yes, yes! Tell him to bring ***all*** his wigs.

MR. HATCHERY: Mother Goose stitched all the wigs together. *(flapping her wings she lowers the giant wig onto HD's bald head)* When Humpty woke up, he had a fine head of hair. *(Humpty wakes up, feels his head, perhaps tosses his new mane of hair and assumes a new persona – think "hip" Elvis Presley)*

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HUMPTY: *(*singing and performing in the style of Elvis Presley; adds in a death drop/half split)*

MR. HATCHERY: With his egg-citing new look and attitude, Humpty Dumpty became a big star. He does two shows a day and when he falls . . .

HUMPTY: *(*continues the performance; adds in a death drop/half split)*

MR. HATCHERY: . . . the crowd goes wild!

STUDENTS: *(screaming Humpty's name as if at a rock concert)*

MRS. BOARDERING: *(entering from the hallway, she's shocked at what she sees; the students go silent)* Sorry I took so long, Mr. Hatchery. Is everything OK?

MR. HATCHERY: Oh, yes, Mrs. Boardering . . . everything worked out, "Happily ever after!"

STUDENTS: *(chanting Humpty's name)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2005 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
MN State Qualifier

**Video of Elvis Presley's Jail House Rock can be found here:*
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gj0Rz-uP4Mk

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